LANGUAGE CERTIFICATES

IELTS or TOEFL, and what the new TOEFL score means

SWIPE →

LANGUAGE CERTIFICATES

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TOEFL has changed

Since 21 January 2026, TOEFL iBT uses a 1-6 scale with half bands. A section average replaces the old 0-120 total.

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Equivalents

B2 = 4 and 4.5, C1 = 5 and 5.5, C2 = 6. For example, band 5 matches 95-106 on the old scale.

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Read the report

For two years, the ETS report shows CEFR, the 1-6 score and the old equivalent together. The single scale starts in 2028.

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What universities ask for

Berkeley 4.5, Imperial Standard 4.5, Tilburg 5 for September 2027. Some institutions, like Rietveld, only take IELTS.

GOOD TO KNOW

TOEFL is not on the approved test list (SELT) for a United Kingdom visa. SOAS recommends IELTS for UKVI.

SOURCE

ets.org · admissions.berkeley.edu · imperial.ac.uk · tilburguniversity.edu · rietveldacademie.nl · soas.ac.uk

Checked on official pages in November 2026. Confirm the current version before you apply.



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